Institution: The Walters Art Museum
Registration Number: 48.67
Beazley Archive Number: 216093
Fabric: Attic, red-figure terracotta
Shape: Column Krater
Attribution: Naples Painter, Beazley
Date: Classical, c. 440 BCE
Dimensions: H. 39cm; W. 35.2cm; D.31.5 cm
Provenance: Excavated from "Foiano Tomb Two" at Foiano della Chiana, Tuscany, 1879; Acquired by Henry Walters with the Massarenti Collection, 1902

Fabric, Technique, Shape & Condition
Attic red-figure column krater. Slightly rounded rim sloping outward, a concave exterior, and an unglazed underside. The neck is glazed on the interior, with matte glaze inside the body.[1] Columnar handles are attached to the rim by plates; the foot is in two degrees, with the underside reserved. Figures are rendered in red on a black-glazed ground with incised and dilute glaze interior detail. Added colours seen throughout: dilute glaze for fillets, loose locks of hair, pillow strips, and table details on Side A; red for hair ribbons, ivy vine, fillets, and a line around the vase on side B; white for the phorbeia.

Ornament includes a black lotus bud chain on the rim, interrupted on each plate by a palmette with volutes and flanking dots; a lotus bud chain is in a panel on the neck of both sides. The vessel is largely complete, with minor chipping; two small fragments on the foot are reattached, and a large area of glaze is lost from the lower right of Side B.

Fig. 1. Column krater, Side A: symposium scene. Naples Painter, Attic red-figure, c. 440 BCE. Walters Art Museum, Baltimore, acc. no. 48.67. Image © Walters Art Museum.

Iconography The krater is decorated with figural panels on both sides, framed by the ornamental programme.

Side A depicts a symposium in progress. Three male figures, two bearded men and an unbearded youth, recline on *klinai*, each supported by cushions (Fig.1). On the left left, a bearded man reclines nearly frontal, head turned right, gesturing with his raised right hand. A mantle wraps around his lower body and left arm, and he wears a fillet. Before him stands a female auletris in an ungirded chiton, playing the double auloi, supported by a phorbeia. Ribbons secure her hair.

Further right, a youth and bearded man recline on a second kline; he faces left, tilting his head back in response to the music, with his right arm raised. Behind

[1] Oakley, John H. *Corpus Vasorum Antiquorum: Baltimore, Walters Art Gallery*, fasc. 1. CVA USA, fasc. 28. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1992, 14, fig. 4.2, pls. 14.1–3, 19.3.

him, a bearded man gestures with his left hand; his right hand holds an ivy vine, now largely lost. A table is placed before his couches. The inclusion of a krater within the scene reflects the vessel's function within the symposium.

Fig. 2. Column krater, Side B: three youths in conversation. Naples Painter, Attic red-figure, c. 440 BCE. Walters Art Museum, Baltimore, acc. no. 48.67. Image © Walters Art Museum.

Side B shows three mantled youth in conversation (Fig. 2). It is understated relative to Side A. The leftmost youth faces right holding a staff; the central youth moves right while looking back; the rightmost faces left, gesturing with his extended right hand. All wear fillets. The composition is more restrained, functioning as a conventional counterpart to the more animated primary scene.

Attribution & Dating Attributed to the Naples Painter by Beazley.[2] The attribution is supported by characteristic stylistic features of the painter's mature red-figure work: the easy, slightly loosened figural poses, the consistent use of dilute glaze for interior modelling of the drapery and hair, and the compositional approach to the symposium subject.[3] The three-youth conversation scheme on side B is directly paralleled by Cleveland (24.533; Fig. 3), where the reverse similarly presents three mantled youths in quiet interaction, contrasting with a more active principal scene. The shared compositional structure and comparable handling of figure types supports the attribution. A date around 440 BCE, within the painter's established period of activity, is therefore appropriate.

Fig. 3. Column krater, Side B: three youths in conversation. Naples Painter, Attic red-figure, c. 450–430 BCE. Cleveland Museum of Art, acc. no. 24.533. Image © Classical Art Research Centre, University of Oxford.

[2] Oakley, John H. *Corpus Vasorum Antiquorum: Baltimore, Walters Art Gallery*, fasc. 1. CVA USA, fasc. 28. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1992, 14, fig. 4.2, pls. 14.1–3, 19.3.

[3] "CHAPTER VIII: THE PAINTER OF NAPLES 1959 AND HIS FOLLOWERS LCS, Pp. 142-158; Suppl. I, Pp. 25-6; II, Pp. 1745." *Bulletin - Institute of Classical Studies* (Oxford, UK) 30, no. S41 (1983): 79–81. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.2041-5370.1983.tb01073.x.

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